

2026 RELOCATION DECISION GUIDE

Palm Beach County vs. the Treasure Coast

Jupiter or Stuart. Palm Beach Gardens or Palm City. Delray Beach or Port St. Lucie. Every area we work in, compared on the questions that actually decide where you live.

14 areas compared

12 decision categories

3 counties: Palm Beach, Martin, St. Lucie

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How to Use This Guide

Almost everyone who calls us about relocating is choosing between two versions of the same life: the coastal, more expensive, better-connected version in northern Palm Beach County, and the quieter, roomier, further-out version on the Treasure Coast. The trade is consistent. Moving north buys you more house, more land and more waterfront per dollar, plus the Martin County school district and Cleveland Clinic hospitals. It costs you proximity - PBI Airport goes from fifteen or thirty minutes away to an hour.

This guide is built to be skimmed, not read front to back. If you already know your one non-negotiable, start with the shortlists on the next page and jump straight to two or three areas. If you are starting from nothing, read the area profiles in order - each one answers the same questions, so they are directly comparable.

About the numbers in this guide

Price ranges in this guide are the asking-price ranges published on our community pages, provided for orientation only. They are not appraisals, not MLS medians, and not a prediction of what any specific home will sell for. School district boundaries, HOA rules, club membership requirements and insurance costs vary by property and change over time. Verify anything that will affect your decision for the specific address you are considering.

SHORTCUTS

Start Here If You Already Know What Matters Most

Most people arrive with one non-negotiable. These are the shortest paths from that one thing to a shortlist of areas.

- **A dock behind the house**

North Palm Beach, Tequesta and Port Salerno give you the most dockage per dollar. Stuart gives you the best fishing access. Jupiter and Boca Raton hold the prestige addresses at the top of the range.

- **Private club and golf life**

Boca Raton has the deepest private-club inventory in Palm Beach County, and Palm Beach Gardens the widest range of club price points. Wellington is the one to check if you want golf and horses on the same property search - Palm Beach Polo, The Wanderers Club, Wellington National and Binks Forest all sit in the village, Wycliffe is just off its southern edge, and The Wellington is due to open in 2028. Palm City is where the Treasure Coast keeps its equity clubs, and Port St. Lucie offers the best public-golf value. Wherever you land, ask early whether membership is mandatory, optional or tied to the deed.

- **A specific school district**

Martin County schools mean Stuart, Palm City, Hobe Sound or Port Salerno. Jupiter's school zone reaches into Tequesta. This is one of the most common reasons buyers cross the county line in either direction.

- **New construction**

Port St. Lucie has by far the most. Palm Beach Gardens has the most at the luxury end (Avenir), and Jupiter has master-planned new construction in between. Juno Beach, Tequesta and Hobe Sound have almost none, by design.

- **55+ living**

Port St. Lucie (Riverland) is the largest market. Delray Beach has the lowest entry pricing. Jupiter and Palm Beach Gardens are the north-county options.

- **No HOA**

North Palm Beach and Port Salerno are the two strongest non-HOA markets in this guide, followed by older sections of Stuart and Tequesta and West Palm Beach's historic districts.

- **A horse at home, or trails at the door**

Wellington, and it is not close. The Village cites more than 100 miles of public and private bridle trails woven throughout its equestrian community, inside a roughly 9,000-acre Equestrian Preserve overlay that makes the low density permanent. The equestrian neighborhoods - Grand Prix Village, Saddle Trail Park, Paddock Park, Palm Beach Point, Equestrian Club Estates - have direct hack access, meaning you ride from your own barn rather than trailering out. At the top end, Grand Prix Village farms trade more like commercial sporting property than houses. Worth knowing even if you do not ride: the trails are open to walkers and, in most sections, cyclists. Hobe Sound and Palm City are the Treasure Coast alternatives for acreage and barns, at lower prices and without the show-season infrastructure.

- **Walking to dinner**

West Palm Beach and Delray Beach are the two genuinely walkable markets in Palm Beach County. Stuart is

the Treasure Coast's answer, at a smaller scale.

- **Flying often**

West Palm Beach (8-10 minutes to PBI), Palm Beach Gardens and North Palm Beach (15-20 minutes) are the practical choices. Port St. Lucie is about 65 minutes out.

SHORTCUTS

The Palm Beach County vs. Treasure Coast Decision, Honestly

This is the choice most of our relocating clients are actually making. Neither answer is wrong - they trade different things.

- **What you gain moving north**

More house, more land and more waterfront per dollar; the Martin County school district; Cleveland Clinic hospitals; and a quieter, less seasonal rhythm. Our Palm City page puts gated golf and waterfront living at roughly 25-40% below comparable Palm Beach Gardens pricing, and Port St. Lucie roughly 20-40% below Palm Beach County generally.

- **What you give up moving north**

Proximity. PBI Airport goes from 15-30 minutes to 55-65 minutes. Palm Beach County employment, the Brightline station, and the county's dining and cultural density all get an hour further away.

- **Where the line is blurriest**

Hobe Sound and Tequesta. Hobe Sound is Martin County but ten minutes from Jupiter. Tequesta is Palm Beach County but twenty minutes from Stuart. Buyers who want both sides of the trade often end up in one of these two.

- **How to test it before you commit**

Drive the actual commute you would be making, on a Tuesday in February - in-season traffic is the variable that surprises people most. Do it once from the Treasure Coast and once from northern Palm Beach County, and the decision usually makes itself.

AREA PROFILES

Palm Beach County

9 areas in this section: Jupiter, Palm Beach Gardens, West Palm Beach, Boca Raton, Delray Beach, Wellington, North Palm Beach, Juno Beach, Tequesta.

Jupiter

Home price ranges

- \$450K - \$900K - Condos & townhomes
- \$700K - \$1.5M - Gated communities
- \$400K - \$700K - 55+ communities
- \$2M - \$5M+ - Golf & country club homes
- \$3M - \$20M+ - Waterfront estates

COASTAL VS. INLAND	Coastal
BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS	Strong. The Loxahatchee River and the Jupiter Inlet give direct ocean access, and waterfront estates with private dockage are a defined segment of the market.
GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING	Deep. Private golf and country club communities are their own price tier here, starting where gated non-golf homes leave off.
55+ OPTIONS	Yes - dedicated 55+ communities in the \$400K - \$700K range.
NEW CONSTRUCTION	Yes. Master-planned single-family neighborhoods and new construction are a core part of the market.
HOA VS. NON-HOA	Mostly HOA. Gated and master-planned neighborhoods dominate the mid and upper market.
HEALTHCARE ACCESS	Jupiter Medical Center in town (ranked in the top 10% nationally for quality and patient satisfaction); Palm Beach Gardens Medical Center 15 minutes south.
AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION	PBI Airport about 30 minutes; Brightline station about 22 minutes; Miami about 1 hr 20 min.
PACE & CHARACTER	A beach town that stayed a beach town - low buildings, no high-rise skyline, and a visibly slower rhythm than the county south of it.
FITS THIS BUYER	Buyers who want coastal living with A-rated schools and club life, and are willing to pay northern Palm Beach County prices for it.
THE TRADE-OFF	One of the most expensive towns in the county, and in-season traffic on US-1 and Indiantown Road is real.

Palm Beach Gardens

Home price ranges

- \$450K - \$750K - Condos & townhomes
- \$650K - \$1.2M - Non-gated single-family
- \$850K - \$2.5M+ - Gated communities
- \$700K - \$3M+ - New construction (Avenir)
- \$2M - \$10M+ - Luxury country club estates
- \$400K - \$750K - 55+ communities

COASTAL VS. INLAND	Inland, beaches about 15 minutes east
BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS	Limited within the city itself - this is a golf-and-club market rather than a dockage market. Intracoastal access is a short drive east through North Palm Beach or Juno Beach.
GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING	The deepest golf-and-tennis club inventory in northern Palm Beach County, from mid-market club communities up to luxury country club estates.
55+ OPTIONS	Yes - 55+ communities in the \$400K - \$750K range.
NEW CONSTRUCTION	Yes, and at scale. Avenir is the largest active new-construction community in northern Palm Beach County.
HOA VS. NON-HOA	Almost entirely HOA, and often club-membership-linked. Non-gated single-family is the main exception.
HEALTHCARE ACCESS	Palm Beach Gardens Medical Center inside the city; Jupiter Medical Center 10 minutes north.
AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION	PBI Airport about 20 minutes; Brightline (West Palm Beach) about 18 minutes; Miami about 1 hr 15 min.
PACE & CHARACTER	Suburban and organized - PGA Boulevard is the spine, and daily life runs on it. Quieter than West Palm Beach, less coastal than Jupiter.
FITS THIS BUYER	Golf and club buyers, new-construction buyers, and anyone who wants the widest price range in the north county under one municipality.
THE TRADE-OFF	You are driving to the beach, not walking to it, and club communities can carry membership costs on top of the purchase price.

West Palm Beach

Home price ranges

- \$400K - \$1.5M+ - Downtown condos & high-rise
- \$1M - \$5M+ - Luxury waterfront condos
- \$900K - \$4M+ - Historic homes (El Cid, Flamingo Park, SoSo)
- \$600K - \$2M+ - Northwood & urban single-family
- \$500K - \$3M+ - Country club (Ibis, Breakers West)
- \$3M - \$25M+ - Waterfront estates

COASTAL VS. INLAND	Urban waterfront
BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS	Intracoastal frontage along the whole downtown waterfront, plus waterfront estate blocks. Ocean access is via the Palm Beach Inlet.
GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING	Yes, but west of the city - Ibis and Breakers West are the country club addresses, not downtown.
55+ OPTIONS	Not a defining segment of this market.
NEW CONSTRUCTION	Yes - new luxury construction is concentrated downtown and on the South Flagler waterfront.
HOA VS. NON-HOA	Split. Condo associations downtown, largely non-HOA in the historic bungalow districts.
HEALTHCARE ACCESS	St. Mary's Medical Center downtown; Good Samaritan Medical Center (Level II trauma center); Cleveland Clinic Palm Beach for outpatient and specialty care.
AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION	The best transit access in the region - Brightline station 2-4 minutes, PBI Airport 8-10 minutes, Palm Beach Island 3-5 minutes.
PACE & CHARACTER	The only genuinely urban, walkable market in the county. Restaurants, the Kravis Center, the Norton Museum and the waterfront are all on foot.
FITS THIS BUYER	Buyers who want to walk to dinner, fly often, or take the train - and condo buyers who want the widest building selection in the county.
THE TRADE-OFF	Condo buying here is building-specific: two units on the same street can have very different association health, fees and rental rules.

Boca Raton

Home price ranges

- \$400K - \$900K - Condos & townhomes
- \$700K - \$2.5M - Single-family homes
- \$1.5M - \$8M+ - Private club & golf estates
- \$1M - \$6M+ - Oceanfront & Intracoastal condos
- \$3M - \$20M+ - Royal Palm Yacht & CC estates

COASTAL VS. INLAND	Coastal and inland
BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS	Yes - Royal Palm Yacht & Country Club and the Intracoastal corridor are the dockage addresses.
GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING	The deepest concentration of private country clubs in Palm Beach County: Boca West, Broken Sound, Royal Palm Yacht & CC, Woodfield and Addison Reserve.
55+ OPTIONS	Not a defining segment, though club communities skew heavily to second-half-of-life buyers.
NEW CONSTRUCTION	Selective - largely infill and rebuilds rather than large master-planned tracts.
HOA VS. NON-HOA	Almost entirely HOA, and club communities frequently carry mandatory membership.
HEALTHCARE ACCESS	Boca Raton Regional Hospital (Baptist Health); West Boca Medical Center; Delray Medical Center (Level II trauma) 15 minutes north.
AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION	Tri-Rail station about 5 minutes; Fort Lauderdale Airport about 35 minutes; PBI about 40 minutes; Miami about 50 minutes.
PACE & CHARACTER	Polished and established. The southern end of the county, and the one that looks south to Fort Lauderdale and Miami rather than north.
FITS THIS BUYER	Private club buyers, families using the private-school corridor, and anyone commuting toward Fort Lauderdale or Miami.
THE TRADE-OFF	The furthest point in our service area from PBI and from the north county, and mandatory club memberships can add significantly to carrying cost.

Delray Beach

Home price ranges

- \$400K - \$800K - Condos & townhomes
- \$600K - \$1.8M - Single-family homes
- \$1.2M - \$5M+ - Waterfront & canal homes
- \$2M - \$12M+ - Oceanfront & A1A estates
- \$400K - \$500K - 55+ communities

COASTAL VS. INLAND	Coastal
BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS	Yes - canal and Intracoastal homes with dockage, with ocean access through the Boynton Inlet.
GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING	Present but not the headline. Gated and age-restricted communities west of I-95 carry most of the golf inventory.
55+ OPTIONS	Yes, and it is one of the most affordable entry points on this list - 55+ communities in the \$400K - \$500K range.
NEW CONSTRUCTION	Limited. This is a rebuild-and-renovate market more than a new-tract market.
HOA VS. NON-HOA	Split - condo and gated communities west of I-95 have associations; older beach-side cottages often do not.
HEALTHCARE ACCESS	Delray Medical Center (Level II trauma) in town; Boca Raton Regional 15 minutes south; Bethesda Hospital East 10 minutes north.
AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION	PBI Airport about 30 minutes; Fort Lauderdale Airport about 45 minutes; Miami about an hour.
PACE & CHARACTER	The most social market on this list. Atlantic Avenue is genuinely walkable and genuinely busy, and the beach is at the end of it.
FITS THIS BUYER	Buyers who want walkability and nightlife with a beach, and 55+ buyers looking for the lowest entry price in south county.
THE TRADE-OFF	In-season Atlantic Avenue crowds and parking are a real daily factor if you live close to downtown.

Wellington

Home price ranges

- \$450K - \$900K - Single-family homes
- \$800K - \$2.5M - Gated community homes
- \$900K - \$3M - Golf community homes (Binks Forest, Wellington National)
- \$1.5M - \$10M+ - Equestrian estates & compounds (Grand Prix Village, Saddle Trail Park)
- \$1M - \$8M+ - Polo & equestrian acreage (Paddock Park, Palm Beach Point)

COASTAL VS. INLAND

Inland

BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS

No. This is an inland market - if dockage matters, Wellington is the wrong side of the county. What Wellington has instead of water is trails: more than 100 miles of public and private bridle trails woven throughout the equestrian community, running along roadway easements, canal rights-of-way and bridle-path easements. They sit inside a roughly 9,000-acre Equestrian Preserve overlay, which is the zoning reason the low density is permanent rather than temporary.

GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING

Deeper than the equestrian reputation suggests - four established private clubs, plus one in development. Palm Beach Polo Golf & Country Club is the big established name: private, gated, golf and equestrian lifestyle together, with an 18-hole Pete Dye / P.B. Dye Cypress course, and housing from condominiums and patio homes up to substantial estates. The Wanderers Club is a private 18-hole club in the village with racquets, pool, dining and fitness, and a strong equestrian connection. Wellington National Golf Club is a private club at Binks Forest, and Binks Forest itself is the established, wooded, larger-lot golf community. Wycliffe Golf & Country Club sits at the southern edge, in the Wellington mailing area rather than the village proper - two 18-hole courses plus tennis, pickleball, spa and fitness make it the closest thing locally to the traditional bundled South Florida country-club community. Coming: The Wellington, a 400-acre private residential club community from Wellington Lifestyle Partners with 253 luxury residences and a David McLay Kidd championship course, currently scheduled to open in 2028. In all of them, confirm whether membership is mandatory, optional or tied to the deed before you write - that answer moves the monthly carrying cost more than the price difference between two similar houses, and at Palm Beach Polo club membership and amenity access are separate from the real estate entirely.

55+ OPTIONS

Not a defining segment of this market.

NEW CONSTRUCTION

Yes, within gated master-planned neighborhoods.

HOA VS. NON-HOA

Mostly HOA in the gated neighborhoods; equestrian acreage is where you find genuinely unrestricted land.

HEALTHCARE ACCESS

Wellington Regional Medical Center inside the village; Good Samaritan (Level II trauma) about 20 minutes east.

AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION

Florida Turnpike about 10 minutes; PBI Airport about 25 minutes; Miami about 1 hr 30 min.

PACE & CHARACTER

Suburban and family-oriented for eight months of the year, then a world-class equestrian destination from January through April. The bridle trails set the everyday rhythm as much as the show season does - they are open to walkers and, in most sections, cyclists, so an hour on soft ground under trees without crossing a major road is an ordinary Tuesday here. That is a genuinely uncommon thing in suburban South Florida.

FITS THIS BUYER

Horse people, full stop - and specifically anyone who wants to ride from their own property rather than trailer to a facility, since the equestrian acreage neighborhoods have direct hack access to the trail network. Also families who want more house and more land per dollar than the coast allows, and who will actually use the trails on foot.

EQUESTRIAN ESTATES & FARMS

The top of this market is unlike anything else in the region. Grand Prix Village is the headline: farms built for the sport, adjacent to the show grounds, with barns, arenas and direct trail access, trading as much like commercial sporting property as residential real estate - buyers are frequently international and frequently buying a business asset. Saddle Trail Park is closer in and prized for the ability to hack to the show grounds rather than trailer, on older stock and larger lots that have mostly been rebuilt or heavily renovated. Palm Beach Point is the acreage play: bigger, quieter, further out, favoured by people who want a working farm setup with room rather than proximity to the ring. Below the marquee names, Little Ranches, Rustic Ranches and the smaller equestrian pockets are the realistic entry point for a working horse family. Never assume horse use transfers with the land - verify zoning, approved uses, the number of animals permitted and any HOA overlay for the specific parcel before you write.

THE TRADE-OFF

No coastline and no dockage, and the winter equestrian season brings traffic, horse trailers on the shoulder, and short-term demand that the rest of the year does not.

North Palm Beach

Home price ranges

- \$400K - \$900K - Condos & townhomes
- \$700K - \$2M - Single-family homes
- \$1.2M - \$5M+ - Canal & Intracoastal waterfront homes
- \$400K - \$1.1M - Old Port Cove marina condos

COASTAL VS. INLAND

Coastal / Intracoastal

BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS

Among the best value on this list. Canal-front and Intracoastal dockage is the defining feature of the village, and Old Port Cove is a working marina address.

GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING

Yes - and unusually, at municipal rates. The village owns the North Palm Beach Country Club, with a Jack Nicklaus Signature course, resort pool and tennis available to residents.

55+ OPTIONS

Not a defining segment of this market.

NEW CONSTRUCTION	Limited. The housing stock is largely mid-century, and much of it is being renovated rather than replaced.
HOA VS. NON-HOA	This is the strongest non-HOA option in northern Palm Beach County - many village neighborhoods have no association at all.
HEALTHCARE ACCESS	Palm Beach Gardens Medical Center 10 minutes west; Jupiter Medical Center 15 minutes north; St. Mary's 20 minutes south.
AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION	PBI Airport about 15 minutes; Brightline (West Palm Beach) about 20 minutes.
PACE & CHARACTER	Quiet, established and permanently low-density - the village's zoning is the reason the character has not been developed away.
FITS THIS BUYER	Boaters, golfers who do not want a private club initiation, and buyers who specifically do not want an HOA.
THE TRADE-OFF	Mid-century housing stock means a renovation budget is part of the real purchase price.

Juno Beach

Home price ranges

- \$450K - \$1.1M - Condos & townhomes
- \$800K - \$2.5M - Single-family homes
- \$2.5M - \$10M+ - Oceanfront estates

COASTAL VS. INLAND	Barrier island, coastal
BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS	Ocean and Intracoastal frontage, but this is a beach town rather than a dockage town - most boating buyers look to North Palm Beach or Jupiter.
GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING	Not a golf market. Palm Beach Gardens is 15 minutes west.
55+ OPTIONS	Not a defining segment of this market.
NEW CONSTRUCTION	Very limited by design - the town is low-density and largely built out.
HOA VS. NON-HOA	Mostly HOA, because oceanfront and Intracoastal condos make up much of the inventory.
HEALTHCARE ACCESS	Jupiter Medical Center 10 minutes north; Palm Beach Gardens Medical Center 15 minutes west.
AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION	PBI Airport about 20 minutes; Jupiter 8-10 minutes; West Palm Beach about 25 minutes.
PACE & CHARACTER	The quietest coastal town in the north county. Uncrowded public beach access, conservation land, the Juno Beach Pier - and no nightlife district at all.
FITS THIS BUYER	Buyers who want the beach itself to be the amenity, and who read 'nothing to do at night' as a feature.

THE TRADE-OFF

Small inventory, few price tiers, and you will drive for restaurants and shopping.

Tequesta

Home price ranges

- \$600K - \$1.2M - Single-family homes (interior)
- \$1M - \$3M+ - Canal & Intracoastal homes
- \$1.5M - \$5M+ - Riverfront homes (Loxahatchee)

COASTAL VS. INLAND

Riverfront / coastal

BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS

Excellent. Loxahatchee River and Intracoastal dockage is the reason many buyers choose Tequesta over Jupiter.

GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING

Yes - golf-community homes are part of the village's inventory, though the selection is small.

55+ OPTIONS

Not a defining segment of this market.

NEW CONSTRUCTION

Minimal. The village is two square miles and effectively built out, and no high-rises are permitted.

HOA VS. NON-HOA

Mixed, with a meaningful share of older non-HOA riverfront and interior streets.

HEALTHCARE ACCESS

Jupiter Medical Center 5 minutes south; Cleveland Clinic Martin North 20 minutes north; Palm Beach Gardens Medical Center 20 minutes south.

AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION

PBI Airport about 30 minutes; downtown Jupiter 3-5 minutes; Stuart about 20 minutes.

PACE & CHARACTER

The smallest and quietest municipality on this list - a two-square-mile village where the river, not the highway, is the organizing feature.

FITS THIS BUYER

River and dock buyers who want Jupiter school-zone access without Jupiter's traffic or its beachfront pricing.

THE TRADE-OFF

Very small inventory. In any given month there may be only a handful of homes on market in the tier you want.

AREA PROFILES

Martin County

4 areas in this section: Stuart, Hobe Sound, Palm City, Port Salerno.

Stuart

Home price ranges

- \$400K - \$900K - Downtown & historic homes
- \$400K - \$750K - Single-family suburban
- \$800K - \$4M+ - Waterfront & river homes
- \$600K - \$5M+ - Hutchinson Island oceanfront

COASTAL VS. INLAND

Coastal / riverfront

BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS

As good as it gets in our service area. World-class inshore and offshore fishing, river and inlet access, and waterfront homes with dockage across several price tiers.

GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING

Present, but Palm City next door carries the gated golf and country club inventory.

55+ OPTIONS

Not a defining segment of the city's inventory.

NEW CONSTRUCTION

Limited within the city - Martin County growth restrictions are the reason the low-density character has held.

HOA VS. NON-HOA

Mixed. Downtown and historic homes are frequently non-HOA; Hutchinson Island is condo and association territory.

HEALTHCARE ACCESS

Cleveland Clinic Martin North and Martin South hospitals, both in Stuart. Jupiter Medical Center about 45 minutes south.

AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION

Port St. Lucie 20 minutes; Jupiter 30 minutes; PBI Airport about 55 minutes; West Palm Beach about an hour.

PACE & CHARACTER

A preserved historic downtown with a real Main Street. Osceola Street has restaurants, galleries and live music at a scale most cities five times its size do not manage.

FITS THIS BUYER

Boaters and anglers, downtown-walkability buyers, and families targeting the Martin County school district.

THE TRADE-OFF

You are an hour from West Palm Beach and PBI. If you fly weekly or work in Palm Beach County, that commute is the whole decision.

Hobe Sound

Home price ranges

- \$400K - \$900K - Mainland single-family
- \$700K - \$3M+ - Barrier island cottages & homes
- \$600K - \$2.5M+ - Acreage / equestrian properties

COASTAL VS. INLAND	Coastal, heavily preserved
BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS	Yes, via the Intracoastal, with the barrier island on the ocean side. Jupiter Island's oceanfront estates sit at the top of this market.
GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING	Yes - gated golf communities are part of the mainland inventory.
55+ OPTIONS	Not a defining segment of this market.
NEW CONSTRUCTION	Deliberately limited. The low-density character here is legally protected, and the surrounding state park and refuge land is not going anywhere.
HOA VS. NON-HOA	Mixed - gated golf communities have associations, while acreage and older Old Florida streets often do not.
HEALTHCARE ACCESS	Jupiter Medical Center 15 minutes south; Cleveland Clinic Martin North about 25 minutes north.
AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION	Jupiter 10 minutes; PBI Airport about 35 minutes; Stuart 25 minutes.
PACE & CHARACTER	The most preserved, nature-first community in our service area. Blowing Rocks Preserve and Jonathan Dickinson State Park flank it on both sides.
FITS THIS BUYER	Buyers who want Martin County schools with Jupiter's amenities ten minutes away, without Jupiter's density or pricing.
THE TRADE-OFF	Very little retail and dining of its own - you are driving to Jupiter or Stuart for most of it.

Palm City

Home price ranges

- \$400K - \$800K - Non-gated single-family
- \$500K - \$1.5M - Gated golf communities
- \$900K - \$4M+ - Waterfront & river estates
- \$600K - \$3M+ - Harbour Ridge (equity club)

COASTAL VS. INLAND	Riverfront / inland
BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS	Yes - St. Lucie River access and dockage, and Harbour Ridge has a marina with direct Atlantic access.

GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING	This is the Treasure Coast's gated-golf market. Harbour Ridge Yacht & Country Club is the headline address.
55+ OPTIONS	Not a defining segment, though the equity club communities skew older.
NEW CONSTRUCTION	Yes, within gated communities, at a smaller scale than Port St. Lucie.
HOA VS. NON-HOA	Mostly HOA in the gated communities; genuinely unrestricted acreage exists out in Palm City Farms.
HEALTHCARE ACCESS	Cleveland Clinic Martin North and South, both about 15 minutes east in Stuart. Jupiter Medical Center about 35 minutes south.
AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION	Stuart 10 minutes; Port St. Lucie 20 minutes; PBI Airport about 55 minutes.
PACE & CHARACTER	Quiet, residential and family-oriented. The draw is what you get per dollar, not what there is to do on a Friday night.
FITS THIS BUYER	Buyers who want gated golf or waterfront living inside the Martin County school district - our community page puts it at roughly 25-40% below comparable Palm Beach Gardens pricing.
THE TRADE-OFF	Little walkability and limited nightlife. Stuart is the town you drive to.

Port Salerno

Home price ranges

- \$400K - \$550K - Inland single-family homes
- \$500K - \$1.5M - Canal homes with docks
- \$800K - \$3M+ - Manatee Pocket waterfront

COASTAL VS. INLAND	Working waterfront village
BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS	The reason to be here. The Manatee Pocket is a natural harbor with charter boats and direct Atlantic access through the St. Lucie Inlet, and canal homes with private docks start lower than anywhere else on this list.
GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING	Not a golf market - Palm City and Stuart carry that inventory.
55+ OPTIONS	Not a defining segment of this market.
NEW CONSTRUCTION	Very limited. This is an older Old Florida village.
HOA VS. NON-HOA	Largely non-HOA - one of the least association-heavy markets in our service area.
HEALTHCARE ACCESS	Cleveland Clinic Martin South about 10 minutes north; Martin North about 15 minutes; Jupiter Medical Center about 30 minutes south.
AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION	Stuart 10 minutes; Jupiter 30 minutes; PBI Airport about 55 minutes.
PACE & CHARACTER	A genuine working waterfront - charter boats, seafood restaurants on the water, and none of the polish of the coast to the south.

FITS THIS BUYER

Boat owners who want dockage and Martin County schools at prices Palm Beach County stopped offering years ago.

THE TRADE-OFF

Small market, older housing stock, and an unpolished village character that will not suit every buyer.

AREA PROFILES

St. Lucie County

1 area in this section: Port St. Lucie.

Port St. Lucie

Home price ranges

- \$400K - \$600K - Single-family homes
- \$450K - \$900K - Tradition / new construction
- \$400K - \$750K - 55+ active adult (Riverland)
- \$500K - \$2M+ - Waterfront & canal homes
- \$400K - \$1.2M - Golf community homes (PGA Village)

COASTAL VS. INLAND	Inland, with canal frontage
BOATING & WATERFRONT ACCESS	Canal-front homes are common and affordable, but ocean access is less direct than from Stuart or Port Salerno.
GOLF & PRIVATE-CLUB LIVING	Excellent value. Three championship public courses at PGA Golf Club, plus golf community homes starting at the bottom of this market's range.
55+ OPTIONS	Yes, and it is the largest active-adult market on this list - Riverland in the \$400K - \$750K range.
NEW CONSTRUCTION	The most new construction in our entire service area. Tradition and the surrounding master-planned communities are the reason many people move here.
HOA VS. NON-HOA	Mostly HOA in the master-planned communities; older non-HOA sections of the city trade at the bottom of the range.
HEALTHCARE ACCESS	Cleveland Clinic Tradition Hospital inside the Tradition community; HCA Florida Lawnwood (Level II trauma) about 20 minutes north; Jupiter Medical Center about 40 minutes south.
AIRPORT & TRANSPORTATION	Stuart 20 minutes; Jupiter 40 minutes; PBI Airport about 65 minutes; West Palm Beach about an hour.
PACE & CHARACTER	New, spread out and still building. This is the growth market of the region rather than a finished one.
FITS THIS BUYER	New-construction buyers, 55+ buyers, and anyone whose budget does not stretch to the coast - our community page puts pricing roughly 20-40% below Palm Beach County.
THE TRADE-OFF	The furthest from PBI and from Palm Beach County employment, and the least established sense of place on this list.

NEXT STEP

When You Have It Down to Two or Three

A guide can tell you what an area is. It cannot tell you what a specific street feels like on a Tuesday in February, which builder cut corners in which phase, or which association is about to fund a project. That is the part we do.

Send us the two or three areas you narrowed it down to and what you are trying to spend. We will tell you honestly whether it works, and if it does not, which of the two you should bend on.

Talk to us

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